

ISMAEL G. MARÍN CABRERA

Software Engineer & Tech Lead

Ruby on Rails · Rust · AI Engineering · Backend Architecture · MCP

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Software engineer and technical leader with deep experience building backend systems, SaaS products, integrations, and engineering teams for U.S. and Latin American companies. Ruby on Rails is my deepest production ecosystem, while I now work regularly with Rust, Elixir/Phoenix, and Python, particularly around developer infrastructure and AI systems. I approach AI as a software engineering problem: clear specifications, useful context, tests, guardrails, and evals. I have worked remotely throughout my career and remain hands-on with architecture and implementation.

CORE SKILLS

Software Engineering

Ruby on Rails · Rust · Elixir/Phoenix · Python · PostgreSQL · Redis · Sidekiq · REST APIs · OpenSearch · AWS · Docker

AI Engineering

MCP · LLM Integration · AI Agents · Evals · Context Engineering · Guardrails · RAG · Multi-provider LLM Systems · Local Models

Architecture & Systems

Software Architecture · Distributed Systems · DDD · Hexagonal Architecture · Monolith Design · API Design · TDD · BDD · SOLID

Leadership & Product

Technical Leadership · Engineering Management · Product Strategy · Technical Discovery · MVP Development · Mentoring · ADRs / RFCs

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Nebula Ideas | **Head of Strategy / Technical Advisor** | 2010-Present | Remote · Mexico / United States

- Advise startups and product teams on architecture, backend modernization, AI adoption, technical strategy, and product development while remaining hands-on with implementation.
- Build and modernize Ruby on Rails products, infrastructure, APIs, and e-commerce systems; help founders define MVP scope, technical priorities, and architecture appropriate to product stage.
- Apply a pragmatic architecture approach: strong boundaries where complexity requires them, and simpler designs where speed, cost, and learning matter more.
- Develop AI engineering and developer tooling across Ruby, Rust, Elixir, and Python.

Dealerware | **Software Engineer → Senior Software Engineer → Tech Lead** | May 2022-April 2026 | Remote · U.S. SaaS

- Promoted from Software Engineer to Senior Software Engineer and then Tech Lead while remaining an active contributor across a large Rails ecosystem.
- Led technical work for an integrations-focused team, collaborating with backend engineers, QA, DevOps, product, and external partners.
- Worked on distributed systems processing approximately 10,000 telematics events per minute and on integrations supporting vehicle lifecycle and daily operational workflows.
- Architected and implemented Auth0-based enterprise identity and SSO integrations, plus role-aware analytics integrations with Databricks and ThoughtSpot.
- Led a zero-downtime Elasticsearch → OpenSearch migration that materially reduced infrastructure cost while preserving production availability.
- Redesigned legacy vehicle classification logic to support multiple manufacturers, VIN-derived trim validation, and richer vehicle classification.
- Authored 40+ ADRs/RFCs and contributed 370+ merged pull requests across 20+ production repositories.

3Pillar Global | **Lead Software Engineer** | Sep 2020-Oct 2021 | Remote

- Designed an end-to-end internationalization architecture spanning backend, frontend, and third-party integrations.
- Modernized legacy Rails systems using clearer domain boundaries, service objects, and automated testing; worked on REST APIs and performance-sensitive distributed services, including Go components.

United Virtualities | Lead Software Engineer | Aug 2019-Aug 2020 | Remote

- Led projects from technical discovery and architecture through implementation and AWS production deployment across e-commerce, startup MVP, and web application engagements.
- Served as technical lead and client-facing engineering contact, balancing architecture, delivery timelines, budgets, and evolving requirements.

Reservamos / reserhub | Tech Lead, B2B | Aug 2018-Aug 2019 | Remote

- Helped create and grow the B2B product area and designed integrations between enterprise transportation partners and the Reservamos platform.
- Led cross-functional delivery of white-label products and partner integrations, working directly with customer technology teams on APIs and implementation approaches.

MagmaLabs | Staff Engineering Manager / Lead Engineer | Feb 2016-Aug 2018 | Remote

- Progressed through three leadership levels; oversaw delivery across customer projects through Engineering Managers / Project Managers and acted as an escalation point for delivery and customer concerns.
- Coordinated with Sales when technical work exposed expansion opportunities and led engineering work across Rails e-commerce systems, Spree/Solidus, payments, subscriptions, and international checkout workflows.
- Helped run the Hacker Academy mentoring program for 30+ early-career engineers and owned hiring, mentoring, 1:1s, career development, and engineering quality across teams.

OPEN SOURCE & AI ENGINEERING

- rails-ai-bridge (Ruby): MCP and context infrastructure that lets AI coding assistants understand real Rails applications through generated project context and read-only introspection.
- ruby-skill-bench (Ruby): evaluation framework for measuring whether engineering skills and additional context improve AI-agent performance using isolated runs, baseline-vs-context comparison, and blind judging.
- rails-agent-skills / ruby-core-skills: engineering skill libraries covering Rails, Ruby, testing, refactoring, architecture, security, and development practices for coding agents.
- Rust tooling: projects such as rs-guard and other developer-infrastructure experiments focused on local/CI execution, agent workflows, persistent context, and memory-safe CLI systems.
- Elixir/Phoenix: author of an engineering skill collection covering Phoenix, LiveView, Ecto, architecture, and agent-assisted development.

MENTORING & ENGINEERING DEVELOPMENT

- The Hybrid Group: mentored four engineers transitioning into Ruby development and progressing toward senior-level responsibilities through code review, technical guidance, and structured growth.
- MagmaLabs Hacker Academy: helped guide a cohort of 30+ recent graduates and early-career developers, with selected participants moving into full-time engineering roles.

EDUCATION

Graduate Studies in Information Technology — ITESO, Jesuit University of Guadalajara · 2005-2007

B.S. Information Technology & Business Administration — UNIVER León · 2002-2005

Languages: Spanish (Native) · English (C1 professional proficiency)

TECHNICAL WRITING & PUBLIC COMMUNICATION

- Technical writer on software architecture and AI engineering at medium.com/@igmarin; regular contributor on AI adoption and its limits for Radio Fórmula.